

Musical of Flavors – An Exclusive Memory from Morningsiders

September 11th, 2024



Formal hall dinner is the TIPPING POINT when the accumulated criticism of barely edible food is temporarily overshadowed by the bliss of the incoming feast. Even before the clock ticks 7:00 PM, the dining hall had been overflowing with crowds, and joy, and delight, and wonder. The appetizing journey kicked off with a warm welcome address by our college master, with his calm, peaceful tone lingering in the air. Excitement piled up; and finally unleashed when the master struck the gong, signalling the climax with the ringing echoes.

All that is worth the waiting. A plateful of extravaganza was served in front of me, presenting a visual stimulus through the combination of vivid colours, like a painter's palette. The ribeye steak is the legendary rock star, nonchalantly strolling into the spotlight. Behind the dark-brown manliness exterior, there is a tender, medium-rare ambition hidden within the zesty marbling, melting in the mouth. It must have endured the sizzling challenge for its succulent flavour, ignited by the Maillard reaction. I took another savoury bite, eager to investigate the harmonic interaction between the steak and gravy. Just of a sudden, the steak was elegantly adorned with the well-tailored gravy skirt, perfumed with a buttery aroma. Even the most delectable potato wedges in the world had to humbly yield when facing with the steak's royal essence. I mindfully appreciate the spectacle of the mix-and-match of side dishes as they intermingle and unfold alongside the steak, bursting forth with flavour combinations.

I sat with a group of friends, partook in light conversation, savoured my food leisurely. I was intoxicated, without noticing the swift passage of time. How I wish we could seal the moment, frozen in time! Fortunately, the memories were saved eternally in pixels, through the lens of my DSLR camera...

The Night Owl's Midnight Diner Delicacy

September 16th, 2024



Midnight, reserved for owls, is the time to flee from the hustle and bustle of everyday life. You know the owl is again launching the self-dedicated cafeteria business when his hand reaches the seasoning stand.

The late-night diner never asks for meticulous plating, nor does he fuss over details in any recipe. The primary aim of running the business is to calm the rumbling of a hungry stomach. Casually improvising, he defrosted a pack of chicken cartilage with a stream of boiling water from the dispenser. Along with the drizzle of dark, umami-rich soy sauce and a spoonful of thick, glossy oyster sauce, he patiently waited as the marinade transformed the humble chicken cartilage into an awakening beast.

As soon as it hit the right timing, he placed the cartilage onto a sizzling pan. Almost simultaneously, the sauces began to caramelize, filling the pantry with tantalizing aroma. He watched the coating turning into a crispy, golden outer shell, with amusement. With two drops of peppercorn oil to further enhance the dish's profile, the night owl was ready to enjoy his feast!

Cut loose, footloose, and fancy-free. As the night owl seasons his food, he is also spicing up the frantic pace of college life.

To Host a Dessert Tasting Night

September 22nd, 2024



Never should we relinquish the opportunity to educate ourselves with LITTLE EFFORT for a pot of Hong Kong-styled coconut sago and serve the fellows!

It was a “dessert tasting night,” for its non-rushing, indulging sensory experience. As I stirred the pot, a mesmerizing silky-white waterfall cascaded from the ladle, revealing the chewy, translucent tapioca balls that formed the core of this delicacy. The pearly sago, boiled with my meticulous care, became a paradise in itself, harmonizing with the creamy, fragrant full-fat coconut milk. A scrumptious dessert, ideal for a frenzied tropical summer and our sweet tooth cravings.

Simply delightful!

Reflective Summary

Interlacing Food Memories with the Intensive Academic Life at CUHK

It has been a long time since I graduated from high school before I wrote expressive articles for non-academic purposes. The journaling experiment in poetic, metaphoric, and literal styles has left me astonished. Transitioning to the third-person perspective in my second entry has contributed to the distant, impartial view of self-reflection and the vivid portrayal of my personality through meal preparations. Most importantly, mindful eating has unlocked my other realm of emotional awareness, which conveys two core messages.

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Food binds people together. Communal dinners in Morningside College hold a symbolic position in my hostel life. It is the sense of togetherness that outshines any imperfections in outsourced meals. Realizing the limited time in undergraduate years sparked a collective desire among my culturally diverse group for further connections beyond academics and interests. Memories become our anchor, evoking the nostalgic reactions that arose from the poetry of ribeye steaks.

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Food is my nightly delight. Amidst the rigors of academic pursuits, food serves as catalysts for baby steps and giant steps. The late-night suppers marked my 9th anniversary pushing past 3 AM and battling through countless assignments, being the source of dopamine rushes fuelling perseverance. My culinary voyage began in Grade 11 as my hands instinctively reached for ingredients in the kitchen cupboard. This was when soy sauce and oyster sauce, the versatile staples in Asian kitchens, emerged as indispensable allies that elevated my dish to new heights. The seemingly mundane act of marination evolved to be a respectful act for the body's cue of anxiety, signalling the moment free from distractions caused by unsolved thoughts.

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As food remains a unifying force among friends and a source of comfort in facing academic challenges, I believe the gastronomic odyssey will hold the promise of nostalgia, found in the simplicity of well-prepared meals.